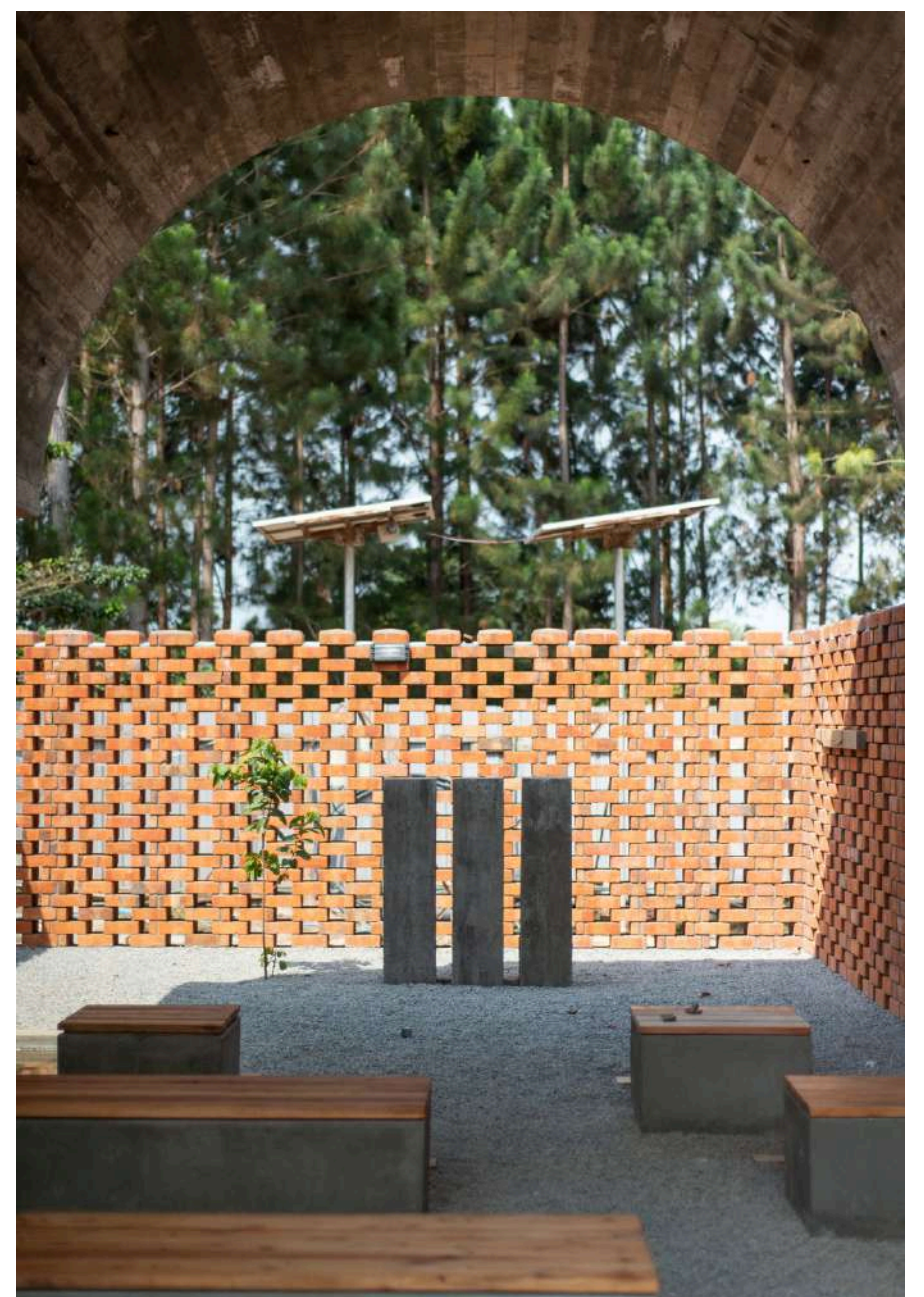
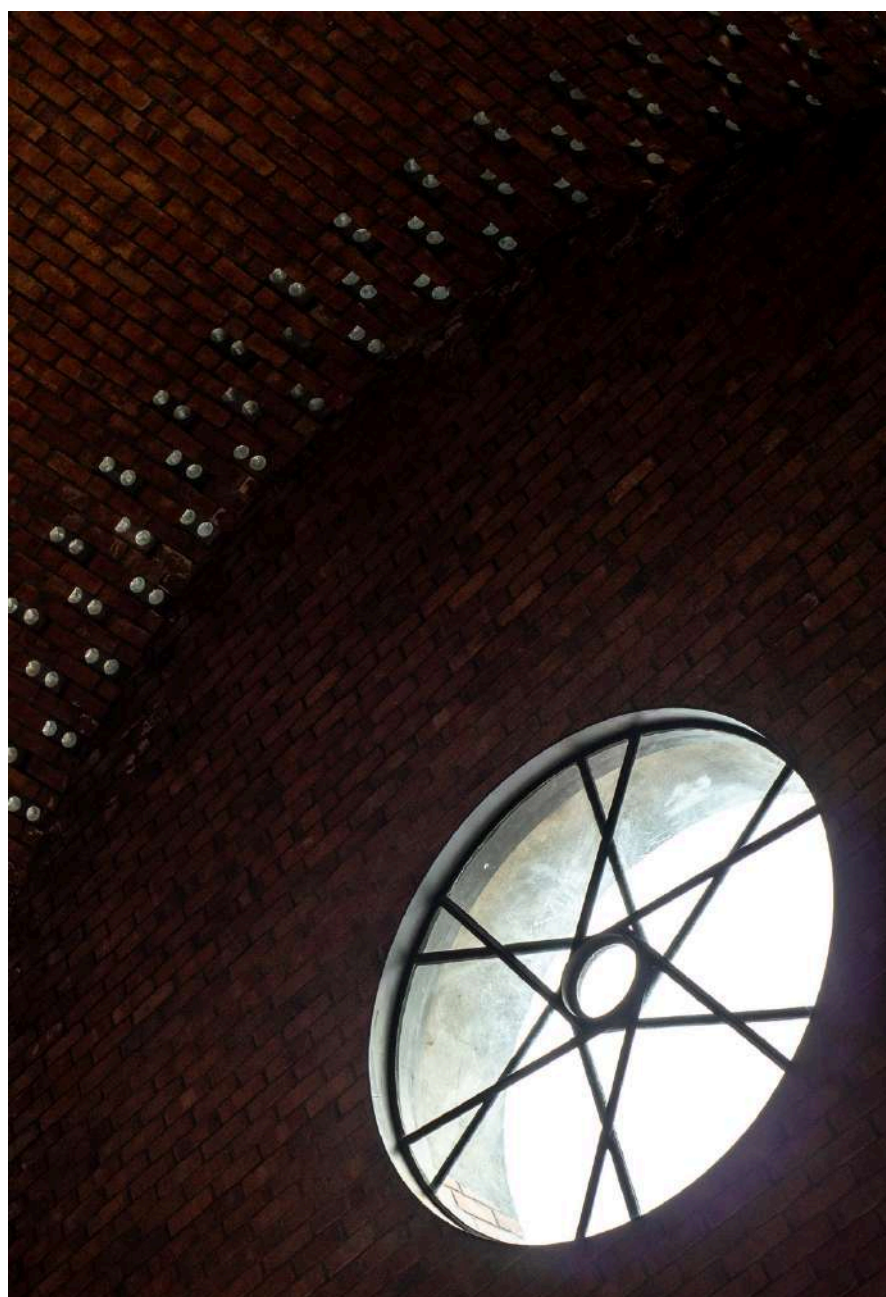
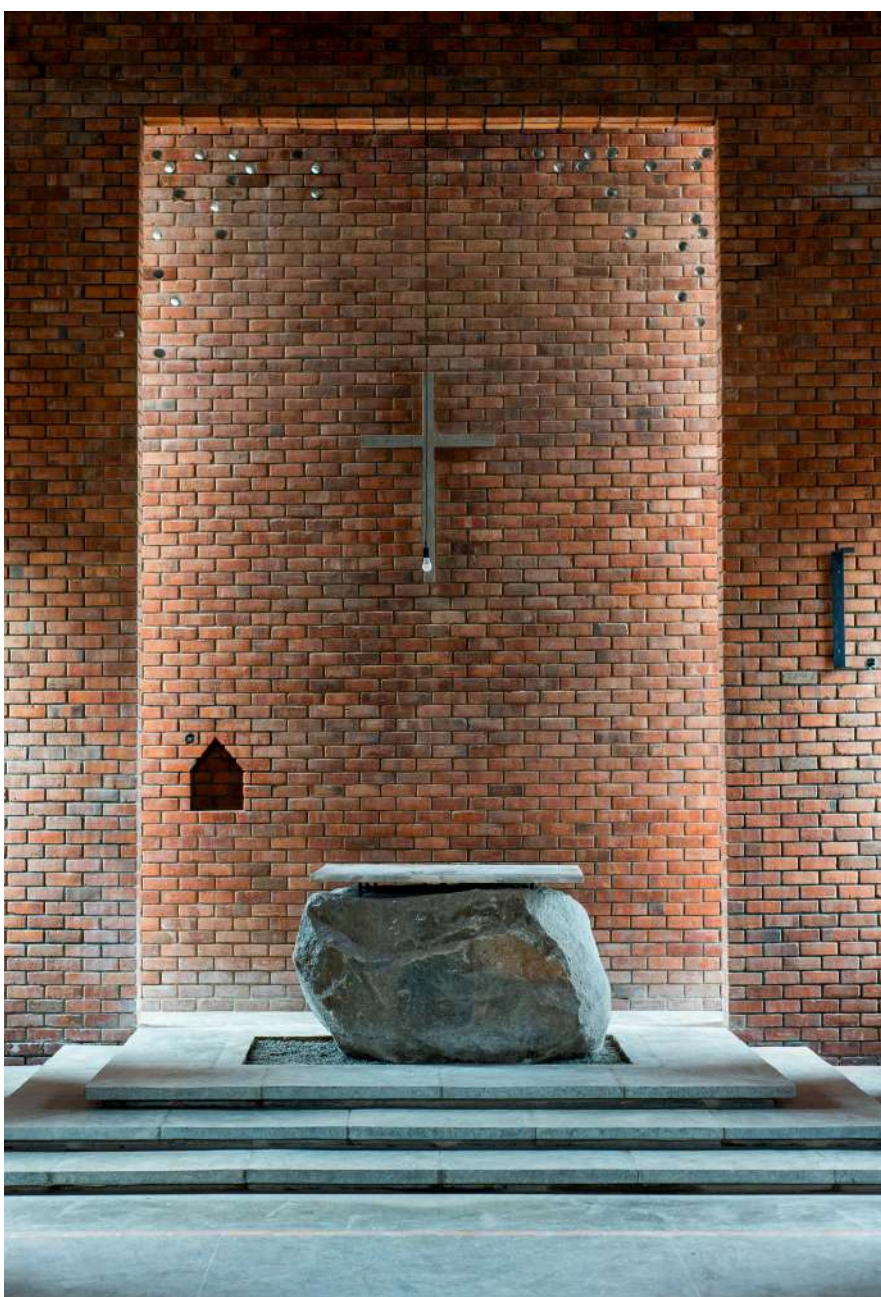


OUR LADY VICTORIA MONASTERY

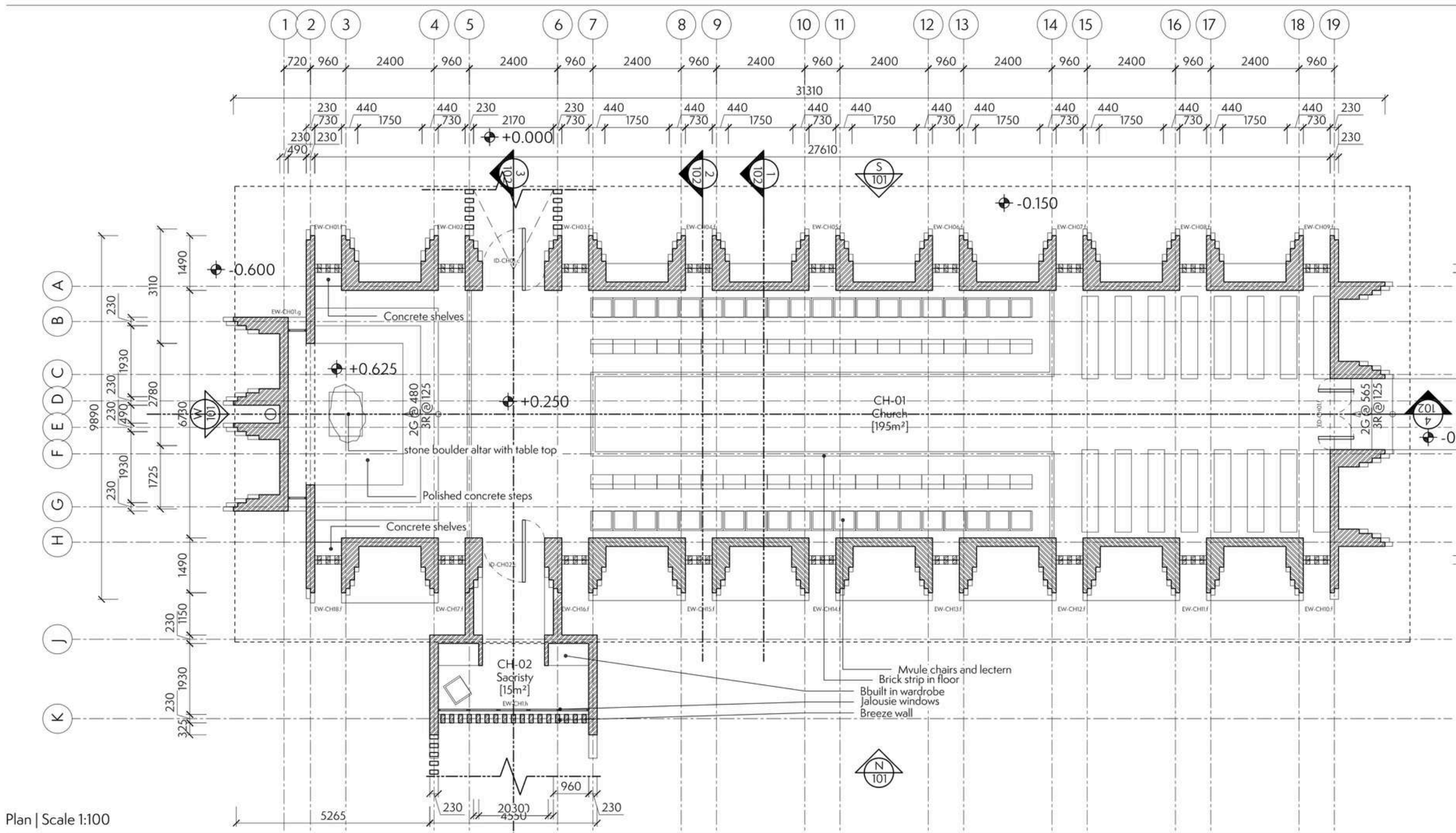


Our Lady of Victoria Monastery was originally established in Kenya in 1952. It hosts a community of monks from the Cistercian Trappist order who moved to Uganda in 2008 following post-election unrest in Kenya. Localworks' architectural proposal followed a requirement to double the existing monastery in size and accommodate a growing community of monks.

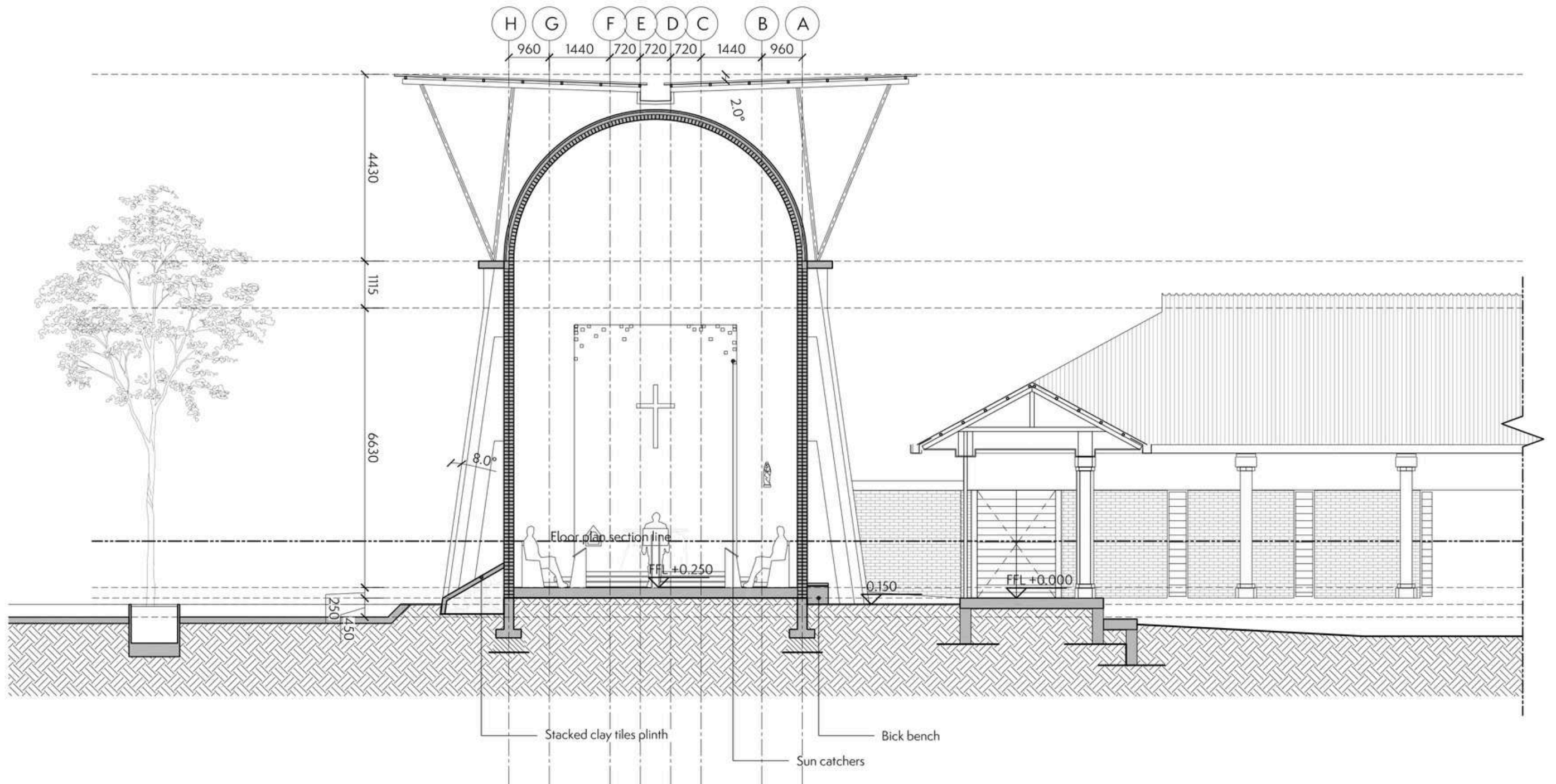
The design includes a total of four new buildings – Church, Noviciate, Guesthouse and Gatehouse. All buildings are intricately detailed in clay brick and arranged around three courtyards.



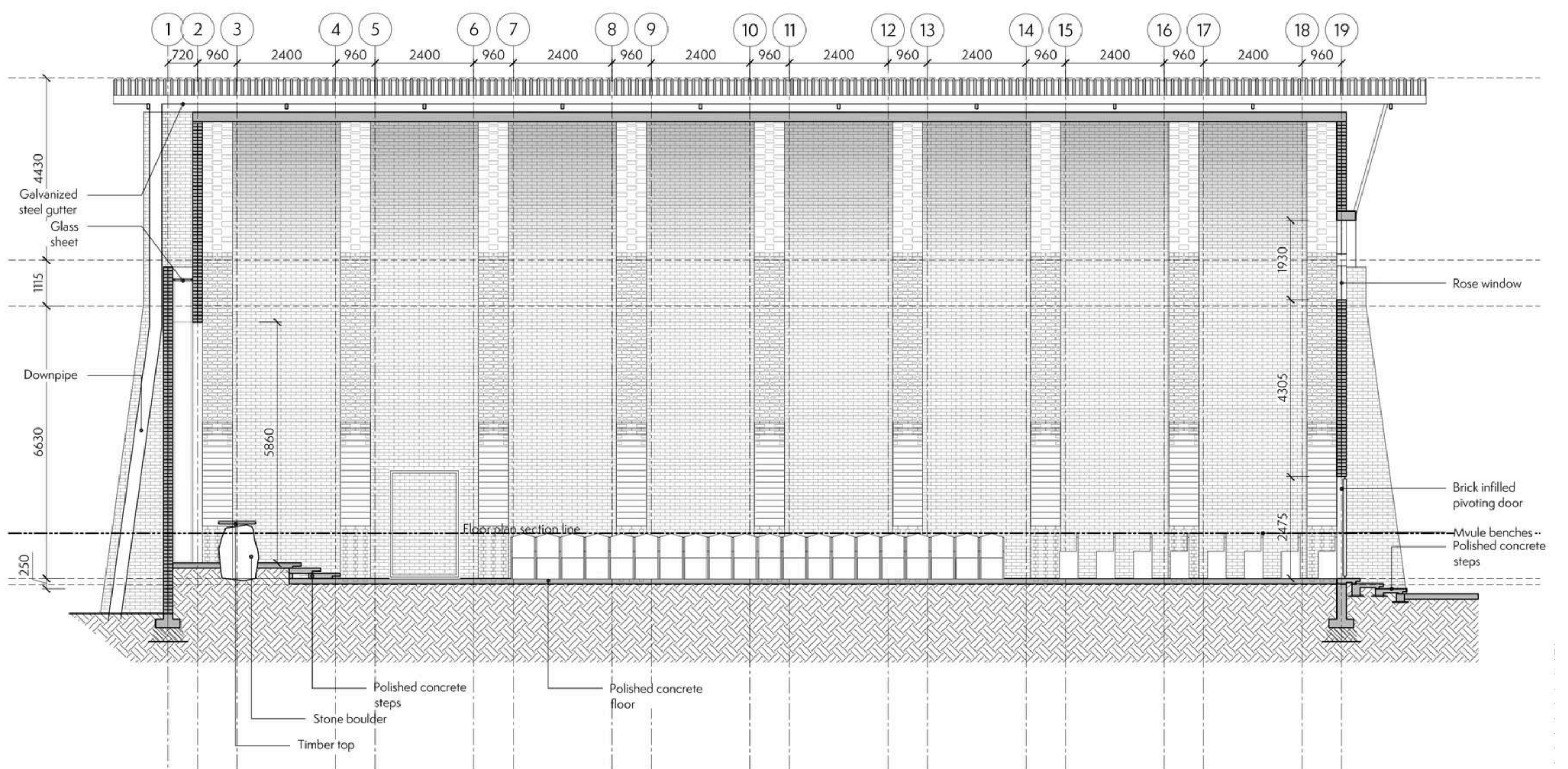
FLOOR PLAN 1:100



SECTIONS 1:100



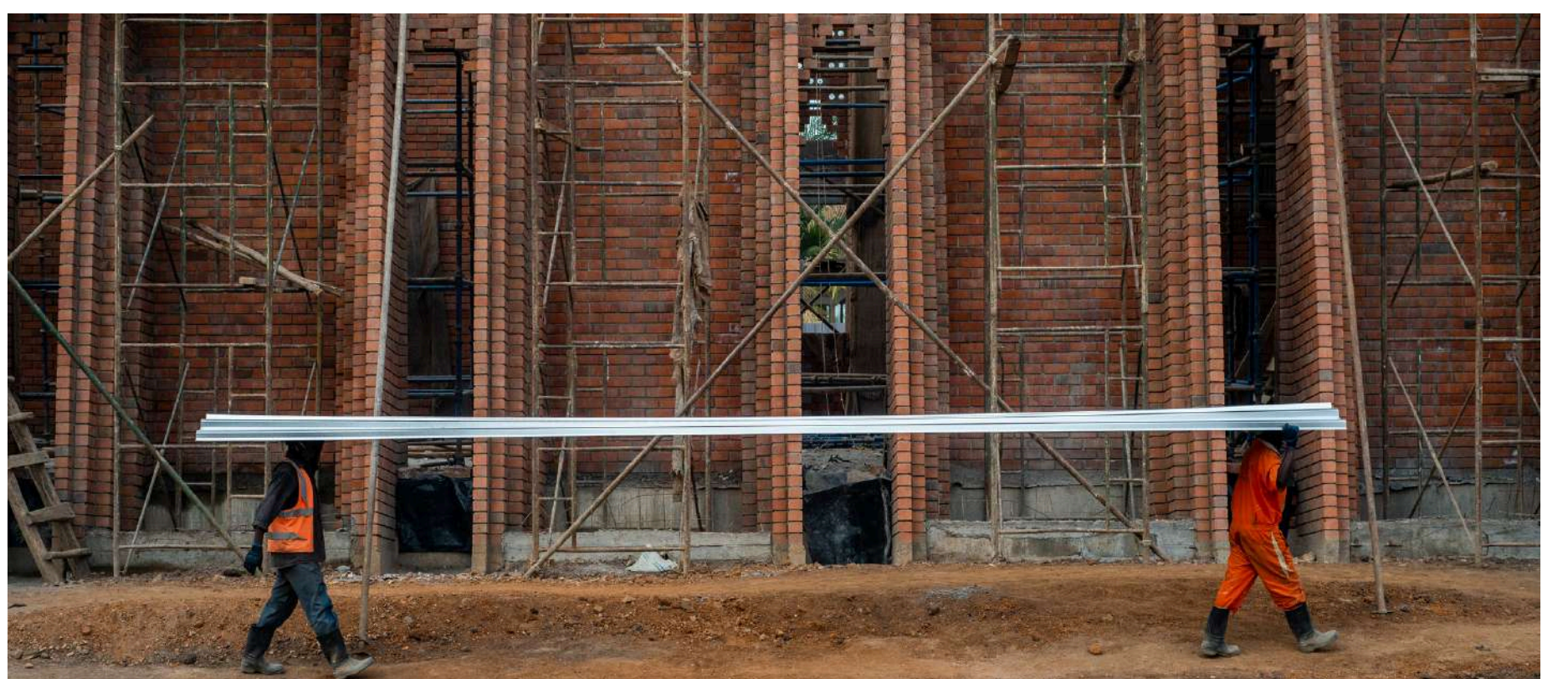
Section 2 | Scale 1:100



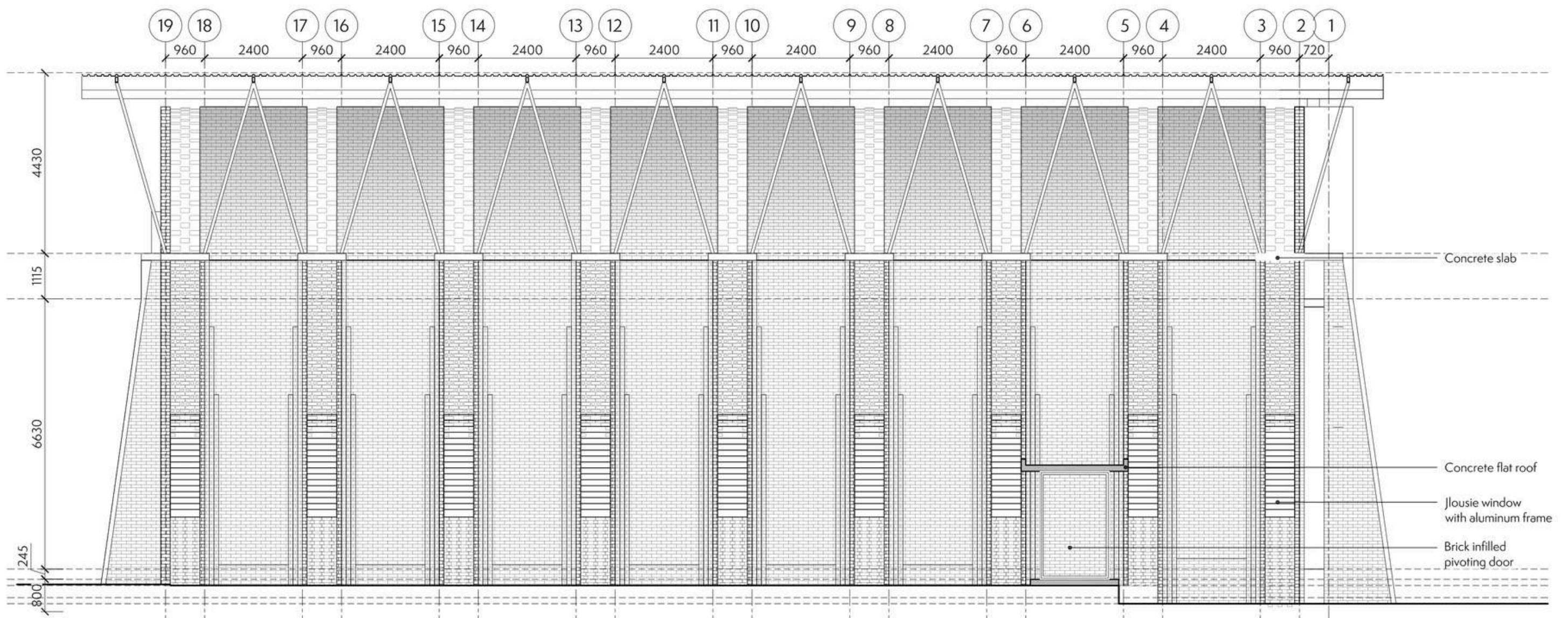
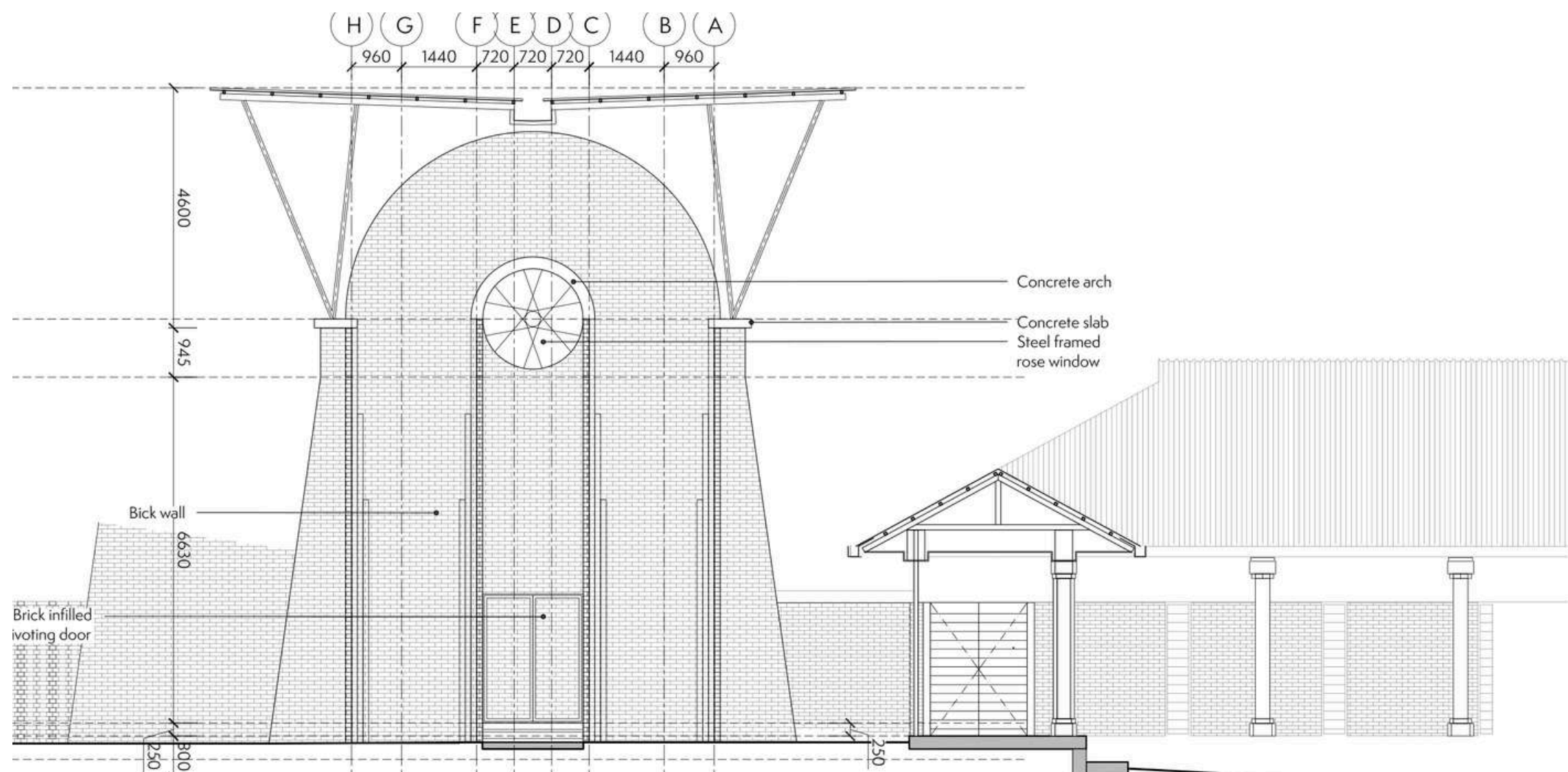
Section 4 | Scale 1:100

Design considerations are closely aligned with Cistercian building traditions of creating pure spaces without distractions from a life of prayer and religious devotion. The church is a long, narrow and tall barrel vaulted volume; it is a direct reference to the architecture of monastic churches.

As traditional as the space is, its structure has been subtly inverted; instead of solid masonry columns with windows in-between, 'columns of light' seem to carry this church, connected by arches made of strips of brickwork interspersed with glass bottles.



ELAVATIONS 1:100



The design makes use of bricks sustainably fired with coffee husks. Using brick as a primary material follows the Cistercian principle of 'material only' – the brick is available close to site, ages well and is easy to handle.

Building the church buttresses in brick by gradually increasing their thickness and depth towards the ground expresses architecturally the structural distribution of loads and moments. All new buildings are passively ventilated, with cross-ventilation, ventilated ceiling voids, reflective roofing material and shaded windows.

This ensures a comfortable indoor climate throughout the year.

